



Shocking twist: In Paris, Vinesh Phogat was disqualified from the women's 50kg wrestling final for exceeding the weight limit by 100 grams, despite defeating reigning Olympic champion Yui Susaki en route to the final. GETTY IMAGES

men's event, sealing his sixth gold medal. Archana announced a shock retirement from the sport after the Games, opting to pursue higher education instead.

There was more anguish in store for fans of kabaddi. The International Kabaddi Federation banned India from participating in international events due to the lack of clarity in the running of the Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India (AKFI).

The court-appointed administrator running the AKFI for the past five years has yet to delegate powers back to the newly elected body of officials. The confusion surrounding the apex body meant India missed out on the first-ever World Beach Kabaddi Championship in Iran.

The event proved to be a resounding success for the host nation, which emerged as the champion after defeating Pakistan 41-34 in the final. Iraq and Kenya were awarded joint bronze medals.

Despite the unfortunate circumstances surrounding the international arena, the Pro Kabaddi League flourished, producing two first-time winners in two editions — Puneri Paltan and Haryana Steelers.

The 70th Senior National Men's Kabaddi Championship was held in Ahmednagar, Maharashtra, where Railways' four-year title run was brought to a halt by Haryana.

There were many high-profile bouts in the world of boxing, none more eagerly anticipated than the clash between former heavyweight champion Mike Tyson and celebrity Jake Paul in Texas.

The 58-year-old came out strong in the initial rounds but eventually faded in his first bout in 20 years as Paul sealed a convincing win. Riyadh hosted another marquee event of the year as Oleksandr Usyk retained his

WBA (Super), WBO, and WBC world heavyweight titles after a unanimous decision win over Tyson Fury.

There was a tinge of desi flavour ahead of the Tyson-Paul showdown as Neeraj Goyat defeated Whindersson Nunes in a super-middleweight undercard bout. Neeraj, who was the first Indian boxer to make the WBC rankings, dominated the fight to secure a unanimous decision victory with a 60-54 scoreline.

The world of amateur boxing wasn't as fruitful from an Indian standpoint, as none of the pugilists managed to win a medal at the Paris 2024 Olympics. Lovlina Borgohain and Nishant Dev were one step away from a podium finish, losing in the quarterfinal stage. Nikhat Zareen, Preeti Pawar, and Amit Panghal suffered defeats in the round of 16.

The Summer Games were also mired in a gender controversy after calls were made to disqualify Algeria's Imane Khelif and Taiwan's Lin Yu-Ting on the grounds that they supposedly failed a gender test. The International